

Stakeholder Map

IIIT Hyderabad Breakfast Mess System

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Use Case

The breakfast mess system at IIIT Hyderabad registers, bills, and serves breakfast to the resident student population across four messes — Kadamba, Palash, Bakul, and Yuktāhār — through a single digital platform. Registration counts, not attendance, drive billing and food procurement. This map identifies every actor, institution, and informal structure that participates in, influences, benefits from, or is affected by this system, and the relationships, dependencies, and conflicts between them.

Stakeholders

Primary, Secondary, and Indirect Stakeholders

Twenty-seven candidate actors were identified across seventeen analytical lenses (student/user, social, food production, governance, money, technology, academic, sleep/time-use, substitute systems, campus infrastructure, waste, health, policy, informal systems, absent/sleeping stakeholders, temporal, and intervention). Seventeen are included in the final map. Four were considered and treated as minor rather than included in full (cleaning staff, juice canteens specifically, and campus security/gate staff — real but with no evidence of independent leverage beyond what is already captured through serving staff, Vindhya, and delivery platforms; guest diners — real but marginal in volume). Three were considered and excluded entirely: a campus health/wellbeing office (no evidence connects it to breakfast-skipping), senior-to-junior norm transmission, and a parental financial relationship (mess fees are bundled into hostel fees, not paid per meal).

Primary stakeholders — direct, daily interaction with the system:

Stakeholder	Type
Students	Human group — registrant, billed party, consumer
Vendor — South Indian (Kadamba)	Commercial
Vendor — North Indian (Palash veg-only + Bakul veg/non-veg)	Commercial
Vendor — Jain (Yuktāhār)	Commercial
Mess serving/counter staff	Human group
Kitchen/cooking staff	Human group

Secondary stakeholders — govern, execute, or manage the system without daily direct interaction:

Stakeholder	Type
Mess Committee	Institution — policy
Mess Office	Institution — operations
Warden	Individual role — vendor management, structural change
Student Parliament Mess Secretary, and a Mess Deputy Secretary per mess (Kadamba, Palash, Yuktāhār)	Elected individual roles — student representation on mess matters

Indirect stakeholders — affected by or connected to the system without direct engagement, including latent (“sleeping”) actors currently inert but holding potential leverage:

Stakeholder	Type
Academic administration / timetable authority	Institution — latent
Facilities/Estate team	Institution — latent
Portal/IT system owner	Institution or individual — latent
Mess Cell WhatsApp community	Informal group
Unofficial mess-tool developers	Individual(s) — latent
Ping (student publication)	Institution — latent
Vindhya Canteen and juice canteens	Commercial — substitute
Delivery platforms and riders	Commercial — substitute

Stakeholder Interests, Needs, and Expectations

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Students	Convenient, affordable, timely food; not paying twice for a missed meal	A functioning registration and billing system, predictable operating hours, food matching their dietary registration	Registering for a meal reliably results in being fed if they attend; being charged regardless of attendance is a known, tolerated rule rather than an agreed one

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Vendor — South Indian (Kadamba)	Contract renewal, predictable order volume, margin	An accurate registration forecast with enough lead time to procure — currently four days ahead of service (previously two)	The four-day forecast approximates real demand
Vendor — North Indian (Palash + Bakul)	Contract renewal, predictable order volume, margin	Same four-day forecast lead time; Palash’s kitchen cannot produce non-vegetarian food, a fixed limitation on its role	Demand for the vegetarian line cooked at Palash and transported to Bakul stays predictable
Vendor — Jain (Yuktāhār)	Contract renewal, predictable order volume, margin	Same four-day forecast lead time; relationship to the other two vendors (shared or independent) unconfirmed	Same as other vendors
Serving and kitchen staff	Manageable preparation and service load, predictable headcounts	Sufficient lead time and an accurate registration count	Leftover food is theirs to consume after student service hours — an informal norm, not a written entitlement
Mess Committee	Balancing student satisfaction against operational feasibility	A functioning process for gathering and interpreting student input	The existing student-input process for the menu constitutes sufficient engagement on mess matters generally, including matters — hours, billing — that process was never designed to cover
Mess Office	Reduced operational workload — the confirmed, stated motive behind its one policy change on record	An accurate same-day picture of intent, currently unavailable at less than four days’ notice	Registration counts are a workable proxy for actual attendance
Warden	Stable vendor relationships, orderly mess infrastructure	Clear division of responsibility with the Mess Office	Vendor management and structural authority remain within the Warden’s own lane
Student Parliament Mess Secretary / per-mess Deputy Secretaries	Representing student interests on mess matters	A working channel into the Mess Committee and Mess Office	Not established — whether this elected seat carries a vote in the institute-level Mess Committee, or only in a separate Parliament-internal mess committee, is unconfirmed

Stakeholder	Interest	Need	Expectation
Academic administration	Its own domain — class scheduling — run without external interference	No stated need connects it to mess operations	No expectation of any relationship to mess governance; confirmed to hold no formal mess role
Facilities/Estate team	Physical infrastructure upkeep	Authorization and budget for mess-facility work (the Kadamba renovation is confirmed to have occurred)	Not established — identity of this actor is itself unconfirmed
Portal/IT system owner	System uptime and reliability of the registration interface	Not established	Not established — no source names this actor
Mess Cell WhatsApp community	Recovering value from a registration that will go unused	A way to transfer a registration since Skip Meal returns no money	Buyers and sellers can find each other informally and transact on trust
Unofficial mess-tool developers	Not established beyond building the tool itself	Not established	Described in the tool’s own documentation as built “for students of IIIT Hyderabad”
Ping (student publication)	Reporting on mess issues as a matter of student interest	Access to information worth publishing	Not established whether coverage produces any institutional response
Vindhya Canteen and juice canteens	Capturing demand when mess breakfast is skipped or unavailable	Steady walk-in customer flow	Not established
Delivery platforms and riders	Capturing demand when mess breakfast is skipped or unavailable	Gate access for delivery, currently restricted	Not established

Formal and Informal Roles

Formal roles attach to every institutional and commercial actor: Students (as registrant), Mess Committee, Mess Office, Warden, the three vendors, serving and kitchen staff, Vindhya Canteen and juice canteens, and delivery platforms all hold a formal, rule-defined position in the system.

Informal roles attach to the Mess Cell WhatsApp community, Ping, and the unofficial mess-tool developers — none of these has any official standing in the system, yet each performs a real function (resale market, public-pressure channel, and an alternative registration interface, respectively).

Roles that are not separate stakeholders. Several categories that might appear as distinct actors are, on inspection, behavioral states or temporary roles occupied by the single actor Students, not separate stakeholders in their own right: attending regularly, skipping regularly, having an early class on a given day, buying or selling on Mess Cell, and using an unofficial registration tool are all states a single student may move through within the same week. Peer influence between students — a roommate or friend’s presence changing whether a given student attends on a given morning — is an internal relationship on the Students node, not a separate “Friends” or “Roommates” stakeholder. Guest diners (relatives, visiting parents, non-student campus affiliates who pay a vendor directly) are the one genuine exception: they hold a materially different formal relationship — no registration or monthly billing cycle — but their volume is too marginal

to warrant inclusion as a full stakeholder.

Create the Map

Stakeholder Map

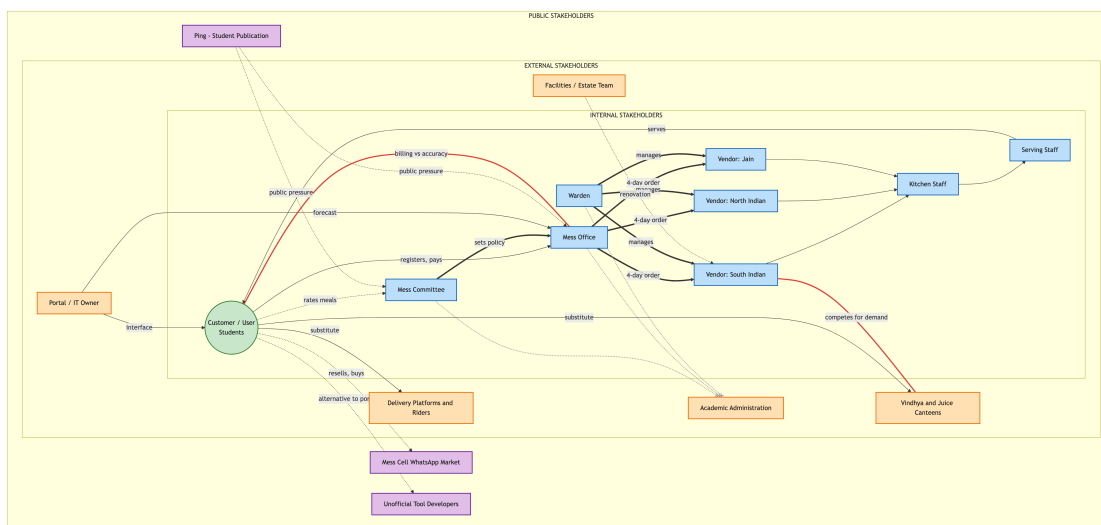


Figure 1: Stakeholder Map

Legend — relationship types

Style	Relationship
Solid line, plain label	Relation
Dotted line	Unclear, informal relationship
Thick line	Institutional relationship
Solid arrow, labeled	Directed flow of information
Red line	Relationship with conflict potential
Dotted line ending in X	Interrupted relationship (no confirmed connection)

Placement follows the standard four-ring model. **Customer/user:** Students. **Internal stakeholders:** Mess Committee, Mess Office, Warden, the three vendors, and serving and kitchen staff — the mess system’s own operating structure. **External stakeholders:** Academic administration, the Facilities/Estate team, the Portal/IT owner, Vindhya and the juice canteens, and delivery platforms — organizations that interact with the system’s boundary from outside it. **Public stakeholders:** the Mess Cell WhatsApp community, unofficial tool developers, and Ping — informal, public-facing actors with no institutional standing in the system.

Relationship Network

This second view lays out the same seventeen stakeholders by functional cluster — core daily operation, governance, and informal/competing — rather than by ring distance, making the full set of information, money, and authority flows easier to trace end to end.

Proximity to the Student’s Lived Experience

This third view clusters the same actors by closeness to a student’s actual morning rather than by relationship type. It surfaces a different finding from the two maps above: Academic administration sits at the outermost

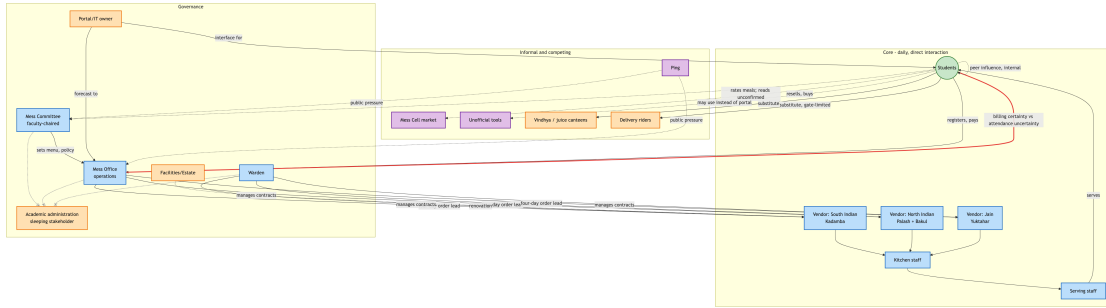


Figure 2: Relationship Network

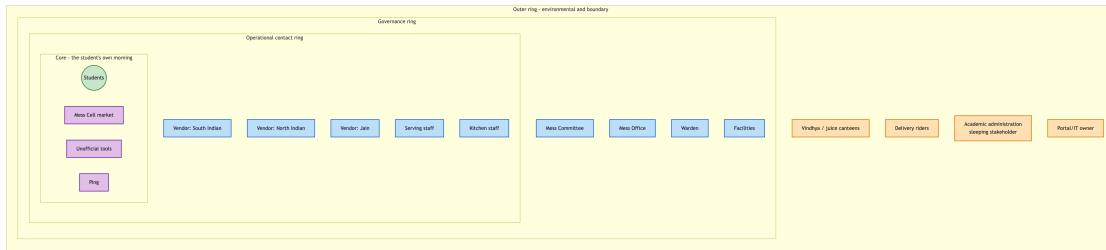


Figure 3: Onion Proximity Map

ring with no adjacent relationship connecting it inward at any layer, while Mess Cell, the unofficial tools, and Ping — none of them part of the formal governance structure — sit at the innermost ring alongside the students themselves.

Relationships, Dependencies, and Conflicts

Relationship Matrix

Cells marked *hypothesis* have not been independently confirmed.

	Students	Mess Committee	Mess Office	Warden	Academic admin.	Vendors	Staff	Mess Cell	Ping
Students	—	Feedback (rating system confirmed to exist; whether read is unconfirmed)	Registration, payment	—	Dependent on its schedule	Payment, service	Service	Payment, service	—
Mess Committee	Authority (menu, feedback)	—	Authority (sets policy)	Hypothesis: overlap	No relationship of any kind	Authority (menu)	—	—	Hypothesis: subject of coverage

	Students	Mess Commit- tee	Mess Office	Warden	Academic admin.	Vendors	Staff	Mess Cell	Ping
Mess Office	Billing, depen- dent on for order accuracy	Reports to (hypothesis)	—	Hypothesis overlap	No rela- tionship of any kind	Authority, depen- dency (order- ing)	Authority	—	Hypothesis: subject of cov- erage
Warden	—	Hypothesis	Hypothesis	—	No rela- tionship of any kind	Authority (con- tracts)	—	—	—
Vendors	Payment, food/material	Authority over	Authority over, depen- dency	Contract author- ity	—	—	Manages	—	—
Mess Cell	Payment, service, informal influence	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

The empty and no-relationship cells are as significant as the populated ones. Academic administration has no confirmed relationship of any kind to any of the three governance actors — a genuine structural gap, not a modeling omission, and the single most consequential finding in this map.

Dependencies

Students depend on vendors for food quality and timing; vendors do not depend on any individual student — an asymmetric dependency consistent with a walk-in pricing structure that requires no negotiation. Vendors depend on the Mess Office for a registration forecast fixed four days ahead of service; the Mess Office depends on students to register accurately, but nothing in the billing structure requires accuracy, since a student is charged identically whether or not they attend — the weakest link in this dependency chain is also the one with no incentive attached to it. The Mess Committee depends on the Mess Office to execute policy; the Mess Office’s own stated motivation for its one confirmed policy change (reducing workload) did not visibly originate from or require Mess Committee direction, suggesting operational pressure may drive policy from below at least as often as governance drives it from above.

Beyond the Academic administration gap already noted: no source describes a direct relationship between vendors and students — all communication routes through the Mess Office or the portal. No source describes the Portal/IT owner having any direct relationship with the Mess Committee, despite the Committee setting policy this system presumably enforces technically.

Conflicts

Conflict	Side A	Side B
Billing certainty vs. attendance uncertainty	Mess Office and vendors need a stable number to order against, fixed four days ahead	Students face genuinely uncertain day-to-day attendance, with no incentive built into billing to report it accurately

Conflict	Side A	Side B
Flexibility vs. workload	Students and the Mess Cell market want more cancellation and resale flexibility	The Mess Office’s one confirmed policy change tightened rules specifically to reduce staff workload
Convenience vs. waste	Students want flexible registration	The Mess Office wants predictable, low-workload ordering
Cuisine demand vs. fixed procurement	Registered uptake is markedly lower at every North Indian line (Palash, Bakul) than at the South Indian line (Kadamba)	The four cuisine lines are fixed by vendor contract, not adjusted in response to demand
Academic schedule vs. meal schedule	Academic administration owns class timing and holds no stake in mess outcomes	Students bear the actual cost of the 8:30 AM overlap with breakfast hours

Findings

Twenty-seven candidate stakeholders were narrowed to seventeen through direct evidence rather than assumption; three lenses that might plausibly have produced a stakeholder — student health, senior-junior norm transmission, and a parental financial relationship — produced none.

The Mess Office is a distinct actor from the Mess Committee, separating “who decides policy” from “who executes it.” Every earlier account of this system’s governance, including this team’s own first drafts, had collapsed the two into one. The Mess Office places food orders on a four-day lead time, administers the registration platform, and issued the one confirmed policy change on record — driven by reducing staff workload, not a student-facing goal.

Academic administration holds the single lever most likely to materially affect the core problem — the overlap between breakfast hours and the 8:30 AM class start — and has no relationship of any kind, formal or informal, to any of the three mess-governance actors. This is the clearest sleeping stakeholder in the map: total authority over the one variable in conflict, zero engagement with the system it conflicts with.

Three real feedback channels exist — an in-app per-meal rating, a public email address, and coverage in Ping, the student publication — and none has a confirmed instance of producing a policy change. Inputs exist; a confirmed output does not.

Registered attendance is markedly lower, relative to capacity, at every mess serving North Indian food than at the South Indian mess, a pattern consistent across three independently operated messes rather than one, making cuisine preference a stronger candidate explanation for the uptake gap than any single mess’s individual circumstances.

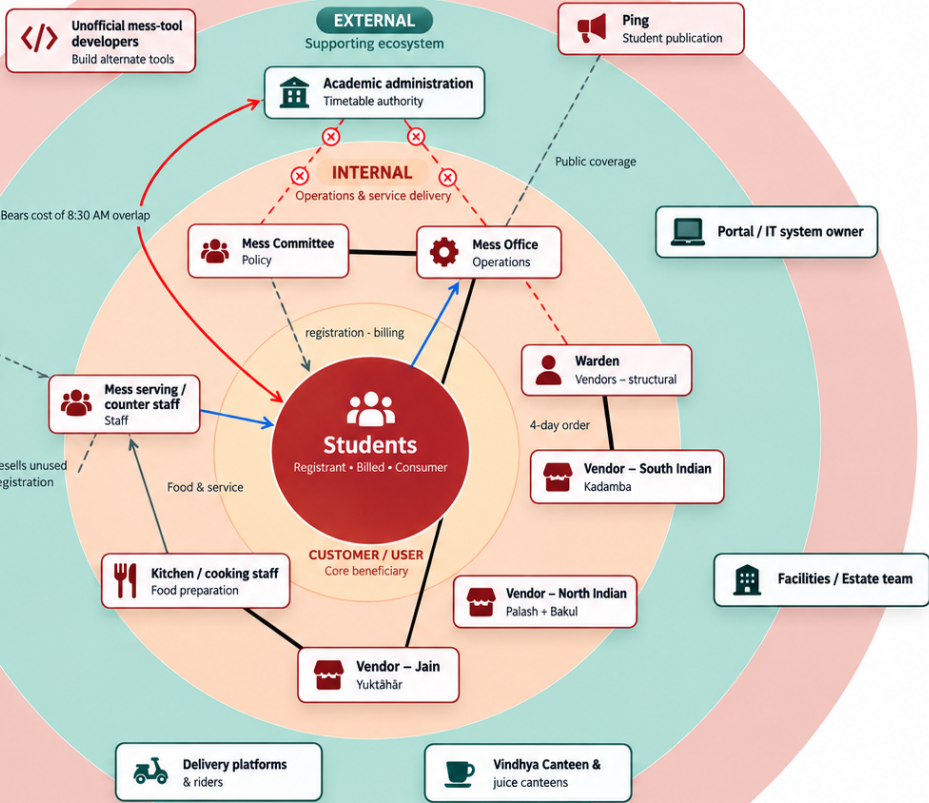
The Mess Committee’s chair — reported in a secondhand, not directly verified source as a faculty member — is a second, more subtle candidate sleeping stakeholder if that report holds: an individual with cross-institutional standing that no student-only channel possesses, and a structurally plausible bridge to Academic administration, with no evidence that bridge has ever been used.

A directly verified addition since this map was first drawn: the Student Parliament maintains an elected Mess Secretary and a Mess Deputy Secretary for each mess (Kadamba, Palash, Yuktāhār), confirmed directly from the Parliament’s own published records — not a secondhand source. This is a real, structured channel of student representation that the three diagrams above do not yet depict; it belongs on the Internal ring alongside the Mess Committee, Mess Office, and Warden, and is carried forward into the Power–Interest/Leverage Map (Task 3) in full.

Two structurally hidden actors carry outsized influence without being visible to any single respondent: the Portal/IT system owner, interacted with constantly and named by no one, and the four-day procurement

17 stakeholders • Four-ring model

100%



9

lead time itself — not a person, but a fixed constraint that caps how responsive the entire system can be to any same-day signal, including Skip Meal, regardless of which stakeholder wants to act on it.